NEW YORK COLLEGE
THE INTERNATIONAL COLLEGE OF GREECE

University of Bolton
Teaching Intensive, Research Informed

BSc Computing with foundation
(Application Development & Data Analyst)
Cohort 5

CLD6000
CONTEMPORARY PROBLEM ANALYSIS

MODULE GUIDE
2024/2025
Semester 1



Level HE6

Contents

1. Key Information 3
2. Module Communications 3
3. Module Description 3
4. Learning and Teaching: Campus Plus 3
5. Graduate Attributes 4
6. Learning Outcomes and Assessments 4
7. Assessment Deadlines 5
8. Assessment Feedback 5
9. Module Calendar 5
10. Formative Assessment 6
11. Indicative Reading 6
12. Guidelines for the Preparation and Submission of Written Assessments 7
13. Procedures for Other Assessments 8
14. Academic Misconduct 8
15. Assessments 9
16. General Assessment Criteria for Written Assessments 11

1. Key Information

Module Tutor	George Prokopakis
Email	gprok@nyc.gr
Availability and Contact Method(s)	Scheduled drop in hours available for support - on campus and/or online
Weblink to Moodle Class	LINK, LINK (GR)
Weblink to Module Specification	Module Specification

2. Module Communications

The Module Tutor's contact details are provided above. You must check your **University of Bolton email address** and the **Moodle** area dedicated to this module regularly as many module communications are channelled through these media.
Your Module Tutor will normally aim to respond to your email messages within **2 full working days** of receipt. However, responses will be longer in holiday periods.

3. Module Description

In this module you will be given a live brief problem relevant to your course of study. This will involve a real issue faced by employers in your industry. Working in a team you will research and analyse the problem you are given before working towards a solution and reporting your findings. A small scale, complex problem from within the industry sector where the solution has yet to be discovered will be presented to the you by industry partners. You will develop and use the skills that you have been taught so far on the programme as well as new problem solving and analytical skills developed in this module to research and solve the problems encountered. You will be facilitated by your module tutor as well mentors from within the sector filed. The module is introduced by a series of workshops, in designing a suitable project to include research methods, business communications, critical thinking, industry practice as an independent consultant, how to develop a proposal, and how to critically reflect and analyse the project and solutions you may have found.

4. Learning and Teaching: Campus Plus

This module is delivered over ***13*** weeks using a *Campus* learning approach which involves campus-based sessions, supported by scheduled online learning.

Scheduled sessions will comprise ***13 Campus Lectures.*** If you are unable to attend a scheduled session due to factors outside your control, you are expected to inform your tutor and engage in any activities set before the next session. To support your learning, online sessions may be recorded and made available on Moodle (for up to one year).

In week *13*, tutorials will take place which will provide you with the opportunity to discuss your progress on the module and receive feedback on assessments. This may be face-to-face or online as arranged.
To complete the module successfully, you must allocate a substantial amount of independent study time, which will involve undertaking directed study and assessment activities. Directed study activities will include preparation for in class activities, background reading and research activities. These are called GILTs in Off-Campus.

5. Graduate Attributes

Graduate attributes are the personal qualities and skills which the University of Bolton community values, and which a student is expected to develop during their time at the University. Graduate attributes act as a point of reference for a student's personal development and support the articulation of employability and transferable skills.
In total there are 10 graduate attributes (GAME). This module seeks to support the development of: problem solving & collaboration.

6. Learning Outcomes and Assessments

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessment No. and Type
LO1: Critically evaluate appropriate sources of information for the production of experiments or solutions	*Assessment 1:* *Portfolio*
LO2: Critically investigate the problem in order to develop solutions	*Assessment 1:* *Portfolio*
LO3: Explain technical concepts to others both orally and in writing.	*Assessment 1:* *Portfolio*
LO4: Critically analyse and observe the integrity and appropriateness of techniques and technologies	*Assessment 1:* *Portfolio*
LO5: Apply concepts, knowledge and/or analytical skills developed in your course to some element of the whole situation or experience	*Assessment 1:* *Portfolio*

7. Assessment Deadlines

Assessment item		Due Date	Weight
001	*Portfolio.* Contextualise findings and report to the industry in a number of specified formats that discuss the solutions and wider implications of the findings. In addition reflect on findings and update PDP.	31/01/2025	100%

8. Assessment Feedback

Feedback on items of assessment can be formal (such as on a signed feedback form) or informal (such as advice from a tutor in a tutorial). Feedback is therefore not just your grade or the comments written on your feedback form, it is advice you get from your tutor and sometimes your peers about how your work is progressing, how well you have done, what further actions you might take.

We recognise the value of prompt feedback on work submitted. Other than in exceptional circumstances (such as might be caused by staff illness), you can expect your work to be marked and feedback provided not more than 15 working days from the deadline date. However, please note that that such feedback will be provisional and unconfirmed until the Assessment Board has met and may therefore be subject to change.

Please take time to read or listen to your assessment feedback. This can be very useful in determining your strengths and key areas for development, and can therefore help you improve on future grades.

9. Module Calendar

Session No.	Date or Week Commencing	Topics Covered	Planned Delivery Method
1	Week 1	Project planning, Topic selection	On Campus
2	Week 2	Time management, Communication, Research in Industry, Research Questions and Proposal	On Campus - MS Teams
3	Week 3	Problem analysis and solving techniques, Analytical techniques, Analysis and Design	On Campus - MS Teams
4	Week 4	Assessment briefing and online workshop. Formulation of research questions and proposals.	On Campus - MS Teams
5	Week 5	Professional Communications and Presentation. Project workshop 1 – Team working tools	On Campus - MS Teams
7	Week 6	Research findings presentation and review. Experimental design strategies.	On Campus - MS Teams

8	Week 7	Project workshop 2 – Project specific. Documenting findings.	On Campus - MS Teams
9	Week 8	Guest speaker and employability workshop. Critical reflective analysis.	On Campus - MS Teams
10	Week 9	Project workshop 3 – Project specific. Organisational Structure, Team working and formation.	On Campus - MS Teams
11	Week 10	Documenting findings, Critical Evaluation. Standards and legal aspects of industry.	On Campus - MS Teams
12	Week 11	Project workshop 4 – Project specific	On Campus - MS Teams
13	Week 12	Revision Session	On Campus - MS Teams
14	Week 13	Feedback tutorials	On Campus

* *Subject to change in the event of any campus restrictions*

10. Formative Assessment

Formative assessment is employed to support your learning on the module, allowing you to reflect on feedback on your progress from your tutors and peers. It takes a variety of forms including and does not contribute to the final module mark. You are encouraged to discuss your work with tutors prior to assessment deadlines. During timetabled activities support is intended to provide a mechanism to allow you to gain on-going feedback on their work and learning as the module proceeds. Online tools such as discussion forums and/or wikis may be used to support these activities.

11. Indicative Reading

i. Chandra V., Harindran A. (2017) Research Methodology. Pearson.
ii. Rea L., Parker R. (2014), Designing and Conducting Survey Research: A Comprehensive Guide, 4th Edition. Jossey-Bass
iii. Bajpai N. (2018) Business Research Methods, Pearson
iv. Qiu M., Qiu H., Zeng Y. (2022) Research and Technical Writing for Science and Engineering. CRC Press
v. Taulli T. (2024) How to Use ChatGPT to Research a Topic. O'Reilly
vi. Rosenfeld L., Morville P., Arango J. (2015) Information Architecture, 4th Edition. O'Reilly
vii. Kerzner H. (2023) Project Based Problem Solving and Decision Making. Wiley
viii. Kallet M. (2014) Think Smarter: Critical Thinking to Improve Problem-Solving and Decision-Making Skills. Wiley

(*) All books are available in the online library of Bolton University.

12. Guidelines for the Preparation and Submission of Written Assessments

1. Written assessments should be word-processed in Arial or Calibri Light font size 12. There should be double-spacing and each page should be numbered.

2. There should be a title page identifying the programme name, module title, assessment title, your student number, your marking tutor and the date of submission.

3. You should include a word-count (excluding reference list/bibliography, figures, tables and appendices).
   Where a word limit is specified, the following penalty systems applies:

- Up to 10% over the specified word length = no penalty
- 10 – 20% over the specified indicative word length = 5 marks subtracted (but if the assessment would normally gain a pass mark, then the final mark to be no lower than the pass mark for the assessment).
- More than 20% over the indicative word length = if the assessment would normally gain a pass mark or more, then the final mark will be capped at the pass mark for the assessment.

4. **At the end of the assessment you should include a declaration of any software tools including Generative AI (GAI) applications that you used in developing and completing the assessment. The assessment brief will specify if and how you can use GAI applications in the assessment.**

5. All written work should be referenced using the standard University of Bolton referencing style– see: https://libguides.bolton.ac.uk/resources/referencing/

6. Unless otherwise notified by your Module Tutor, electronic copies of assignments should be saved as word documents and uploaded into Turnitin via the Moodle class area. If you experience problems in uploading your work, then you must send an electronic copy of your assessment to your Module Tutor via email BEFORE the due date/time.

7. Please note that when you submit your work to Moodle, it will automatically be checked for matches against other electronic information, as well as for hidden text characters and GAI generated text. You will be able to see similarity matches but not currently flags for hidden characters and AI-generated text. The outcomes of Turnitin reports may be used as evidence in an academic misconduct investigation (see Section 14).

8. Late work

Late work will be subject to the following penalties:

- Up to 7 calendar days late = 10 marks subtracted but if the assignment would normally gain a pass mark, then the final mark to be no lower than the pass mark for the assignment.
- More than 7 calendar days late **=** This will be counted as non-submission and no marks will be recorded.

  Late submission of assessments on refer and those which are graded Pass/Fail only, is not permitted unless an extension is approved. See below.

9. Extensions

In the case of exceptional and unforeseen circumstances, an extension of up to 14 days after the assessment deadline may be requested using the standard University Extension Request Form. For approval there would need to be an explanation and evidence of relevant circumstances.

Longer extensions for individual assessments, projects and artefacts may be granted, at the discretion of the Programme Leader.

Requests for extensions which take a submission date past the end of the module (normally week 15) must be made using the Mitigating Circumstances procedure.
Some students with registered disabilities will be eligible for revised submission deadlines. Revised submission deadlines for disability adjustments do not require the completion extension request paperwork. However, students should request these in writing in advance.

Please note that the failure of data storage systems is not considered to be a valid reason for an extension. It is therefore important that you keep multiple copies of your work on different storage devices before submitting it.

13. Procedures for Other Assessments

Source code for the implementation parts, and design documents, must be submitted using the eLearning platform.

14. Academic Misconduct

Academic misconduct may be defined as any attempt by a student to gain an unfair advantage in any assessment. This includes plagiarism, collusion, commissioning (contract cheating) amongst other offences. In order to avoid these types of academic misconduct, you should ensure that all your work is your own and that sources are attributed using the correct referencing techniques. You can also check originality through *Turnitin.*

Please note that penalties apply if academic misconduct is proven. See the following link for further details: https://www.bolton.ac.uk/student-policy-zone/student-policies-2023-24/academic-misconduct-regulations-and-procedures-23-24

15. Assessments

Assessment Number	001
Assessment Type (and weighting)	Portfolio
Assessment Name	Contextualise findings and report to the industry in a number of specified formats that discuss the solutions and wider implications of the findings. In addition reflect on findings and update PDP.
Assessment Date	31/01/2024

Learning Outcomes Assessed:

LO1: Critically evaluate appropriate sources of information for the production of experiments or solutions

LO2: Critically investigate the problem in order to develop solutions

LO3: Explain technical concepts to others both orally and in writing

LO4: Critically analyse and observe the integrity and appropriateness of techniques and technologies

LO5: Apply concepts, knowledge and/or analytical skills developed in your course to some element of the whole situation or experience

Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GAI) Applications in this Assessment

AI Status	Application	Notes
Category C	GAI is an integral part of the assessment and should be used.	Grammar and/or spell checkers may be used to correct individual words and sentences. Your skills in using and evaluating GAI generated content is part of the assessment task in question. GAI generated content should be clearly identified and acknowledged. Any GAI generated content which is presented as your own original work and is not acknowledged will be assessed for academic misconduct.

Assessment Overview:

You will work on a problem involving a real issue faced by employers. Your task is to gather requirements, do the analysis of the problem and provide analysis and design, as well as a research question to be evaluated. Implementation will be provided according to the design. The implementation will be tested and evaluated towards the research question. This critical analysis will result in conclusions regarding the problem and the analysis, design, and implementation followed. During this process you will be creating a portfolio of documents, diagrams, experiments, and other deliverables which will be used as part of your project's portfolio along with a final report of 3000 words describing the whole process and coming to useful conclusions.

Minimum Secondary Research Source Requirements:

Level HE6 - It is expected that the Reference List will contain between fifteen to twenty sources. As a MINIMUM the Reference List should include three refereed academic journals and five academic books.

Specific Assessment Criteria:

As presented in the module brief

(Please note that the General Assessment Criteria will also apply. Please see section 16)

First class (70% and above):

Students will provide extensive research on the given topic with sufficient references and a valid research question to be evaluated. Detailed and excellent analysis and design will be provided along with successful implementation which will be evaluated and will lead to excellent critical reasoning of the research question. Excellent use of team working tools will be evident. Academic style and referencing will be excellent

Second class (50-69%):

Students will provide comprehensive research on the given topic with sufficient references and a valid research question to be evaluated. Detailed and very good analysis and design will be provided along with successful implementation which will be evaluated and will lead to critical reasoning of the research question. Very good use of team working tools will be evident. Academic style and referencing will be good.

Third class (40-49%):

Students will provide satisfactory research on the given topic with several references and a valid research question to be evaluated. Analysis and design will be provided along with working implementation which will be evaluated and will lead to critical reasoning of the research question. Attempt to use of team working tools will be evident. Academic style and referencing will be fair.

Fail (39% and below):

Students who do not meet the requirements of a third-class grade will not successfully complete the assessment activity.

16. General Assessment Criteria for Written Assessments

GENERAL ASSESSMENT GUIDELINES – LEVEL HE6

	Relevance **Learning outcomes must be met for an overall pass**	Knowledge and Understanding	Analysis, Creativity and Problem-Solving	Self-awareness and Reflection	Research/ Referencing	Written English	Presentation and Structure
Class I (Exceptional Quality) **85% - 100%**	Work is directly relevant and expertly addresses the requirements of the brief. **Learning outcomes are met.**	Demonstrates an exceptional breadth and depth of knowledge and understanding of theory and practice beyond the threshold expectation for the level. Demonstrates mastery in conceptual understanding of a range of specialised areas.	Presents an exceptional synthesis and critical evaluation of findings from a broad range of relevant sources in order to draw clear, systematic, justified and insightful conclusions. Provides a sophisticated critical insight and expertly interprets complex matters and ideas. Demonstrates exceptional creative flair and a high level of originality. Demonstrates exceptional problem- solving skills and initiative.	Provides insightful reflection and critical self-awareness in relation to the outcomes of own work and personal responsibility.	An extensive range of contemporary and relevant reference sources selected and drawn upon. Sources cited accurately in both the body of text and in the Reference List/ Bibliography.	Writing style is clear, succinct and appropriate to the requirements of the assessment. An exceptionally well written answer with competent spelling, grammar and punctuation. For example, paragraphs are well structured and include linking and signposting. Sentences are complete and different types are used. A wide range of appropriate vocabulary is used.	The presentational style and layout are correct for the type of assignment. Evidence of planning and logically structured. Where relevant, there is effective inclusion of, and reference to, figures, tables and images.
Class I (Excellent Quality) **70% - 84%**	Work is relevant and comprehensively addresses the requirements of the brief. **Learning outcomes are met.**	Demonstrates an excellent breadth and depth of knowledge and understanding of theory and practice for this level. Demonstrates an in-depth conceptual understanding of a range of specialised areas.	Presents an excellent synthesis and critical evaluation of findings from a broad range of relevant sources in order to draw clear, systematic, justified and perceptive conclusions. Provides a critical insight and clearly interprets complex matters and ideas. Demonstrates creative flair and a high level of originality. Demonstrates excellent problem-solving skills and initiative.	Provides excellent reflection and critical self-awareness in relation to the outcomes of own work and personal responsibility.	A wide range of contemporary and relevant reference sources selected and drawn upon. Sources cited accurately in both the body of text and in the Reference List/ Bibliography.	Writing style is clear, succinct and appropriate to the requirements of the assessment. An excellently well written answer with competent, spelling, grammar and punctuation. For example, paragraphs are well structured and include linking and signposting. Sentences are complete and different types are used. A wide range of appropriate vocabulary is used.	The presentational style and layout are correct for the type of assignment. Evidence of planning and logically structured Where relevant, there is effective inclusion of, and reference to, figures, tables and images.
Class II/i (Very Good Quality) **60% - 69%**	Work is relevant and addresses most of the requirements of the brief well. **Learning outcomes are met.**	Demonstrates a thorough breadth and depth of knowledge and understanding of theory and practice for this level. Demonstrates a sophisticated conceptual understanding of a range of specialised areas.	Presents a perceptive synthesis and critical evaluation of findings from a range of relevant sources in order to draw clear, justified and thoughtful conclusions. Interprets complex matters and ideas well. Demonstrates a good level of creativity and originality. Demonstrates strong problem-solving skills.	Provides very good reflection and critical self-awareness in relation to the outcomes of own work and personal responsibility, as required by the assessment.	A wide range of relevant reference sources selected and drawn upon. Sources cited accurately in the main in both the body of text and in the Reference List/ Bibliography.	Writing style is clear, succinct and appropriate to the requirements of the assessment. A very well written answer with competent spelling, grammar and punctuation. For example, paragraphs are well structured and include linking and signposting. Sentences are complete and different types are used. A range of appropriate vocabulary is used.	The presentational style and layout are correct for the type of assignment. Evidence of planning and logically structured in the main. Where relevant, there is effective inclusion of, and reference to, figures, tables and images.

	Relevance **Learning outcomes must be met for an overall pass**	Knowledge and Understanding	Analysis, Creativity and Problem-Solving	Self-awareness and Reflection	Research/ Referencing	Written English	Presentation and Structure
Class II/ii (Good Quality) **50% - 59%**	Work addresses key requirements of the brief. Some irrelevant content. **Learning outcomes are met.**	Demonstrates a sound breadth and depth of knowledge and understanding of theory and practice for this level. Demonstrates a sound conceptual understanding of specialised areas.	Presents a logical evaluation of findings from a range of relevant sources in order to draw clear and justified conclusions. Interprets some complex matters and ideas. Demonstrates some creativity. Demonstrates effective problem-solving skills and initiative.	Provides good reflection and critical self-awareness in relation to the outcomes of own work and personal responsibility, as required by the assessment.	A range of relevant reference sources selected and drawn upon. Most sources accurately cited both the body of text and in the Reference List/Bibliography.	Writing style is mostly appropriate to the requirements of the assessment. Grammar, spelling and punctuation are generally competent and minor lapses do not pose difficulty for the reader. Paragraphs are structured and include some linking and signposting. Sentences are complete. A range of appropriate vocabulary is used.	The presentational style and layout are correct for the type of assignment. Logically structured in the most part. Inclusion of figures, tables and images but not all relevant or referred to.
Class III (Satisfactory Quality) **40% - 49%**	Work addresses the requirements of the brief, although superficially in places. Some irrelevant content. **Learning outcomes are met.**	Demonstrates a sufficient breadth and depth of knowledge and understanding of theory and practice for this level. Demonstrates a conceptual understanding of some specialised areas.	Presents an evaluation of findings from a range of sources in order to draw some valid conclusions. Interprets some complex matters and ideas but with descriptive passages evident which lack clear purpose. Demonstrates creativity in places. Demonstrates sufficient problem-solving skills and initiative.	Provides some reflection and critical self-awareness in relation to the outcomes of own work and personal responsibility, as required by the assessment.	Some relevant reference sources selected and drawn upon. Some weaknesses in referencing technique.	Writing style is occasionally not appropriate for the assessment. Grammar, spelling and punctuation are generally competent, but may pose minor difficulties for the reader. Some paragraphs may lack structure, and there is limited linking and signposting. Some appropriate vocabulary is used	The presentational style and layout are largely correct for the type of assignment. Adequately structured. Inclusion of some figures, tables and images but not all clear, relevant and/or referred to.
Borderline Fail **35% - 39%**	Work addresses some of the requirements of the brief. Irrelevant and superficial content. **One or more learning outcomes have not been met.**	Demonstrates a lack of knowledge and understanding of theory and practice for this level. Demonstrates Insufficient conceptual understanding of specialised areas.	Presents a limited evaluation of findings from set sources. Descriptive or narrative passages evident which lack clear purpose. Demonstrates little creativity. Demonstrates insufficient problem-solving skills and initiative.	Provides limited reflection and critical self-awareness in relation to the outcomes of own work and personal responsibility, when required.	Sources selected are limited and lack validity/relevance. Poor referencing technique employed.	Writing style is unclear and does not match the requirements of the assessment. Deficiencies in spelling, grammar and punctuation makes reading difficult and arguments unclear in places. Paragraphs are poorly structured.	For the type of assignment the presentational style, layout and/or structure are lacking. Inclusion of figures, tables and images but not clear, relevant and/or referred to.
Fail **<34%**	Work does not address the requirements of the brief. Irrelevant and superficial content. **One or more learning outcomes have not been met.**	Demonstrates inadequate knowledge and understanding of theory and practice for this level. Demonstrates Insufficient conceptual understanding of relevant areas.	Analysis is weak and poorly constructed with inadequate sources drawn upon. Demonstrates little or no creativity. Demonstrates a lack of problem-solving skills and initiative.	Provides inadequate reflection and self-awareness in relation to the outcomes of own work and personal responsibility, when required.	An absence of relevant sources selected and drawn upon. Poor referencing technique employed.	Writing style is unclear and does not match the requirements of the assessment in question. Deficiencies in spelling, grammar and punctuation makes reading difficult and arguments unclear. Unstructured paragraphs.	For the type of assignment the presentational style, layout and/or structure are lacking. Inclusion of figures, tables and images but not clear, relevant and/or referred to.